

Alec Bohm — The Second-Half Turnaround, Audited

UC #38 · uc-pos-013-bohm-second-half-turnaround-001 · dp_uc37 · Phillies Offense value stream · as of 2026-08-22

Data window & reliability. All Phillies batting Statcast, 2015 → 2026-08-22 (2026 data is complete through last night's game). Bohm locked to MLBAM **664761**; 512 PA in 2026 — **377 pre-break, 135 post-break**, both above the standing 50-PA floor. The break operator is the DPO's submitted `game_date > '2026-07-15'` (first game back: 16 Jul; last game before: 12 Jul). Cells below the 50-PA floor are marked **△** everywhere they appear and no ranking leans on them. Every number in this report was recomputed on an independent code path: **227/227 PASS**.

§1 · The verdicts — every submitted premise, answered before anything is explained

#	Premise as submitted	Verdict	The number
1	He has turned his season around since the All-Star break	TRUE — and it survives every alternate breakpoint	SLG .351 → .488 , BA .214 → .336, wOBA .278 → .374. The 10-point sensitivity scan never finds a negative delta
2	He is "hitting the ball much better" (contact, not just outcomes)	TRUE	Hard-hit 40.8% → 46.9% , mean EV 90.1 → 91.7 mph , xwOBACon .313 → .404 , barrel 5.2% → 7.1%
3	His run production is a boon to the middle of the lineup	TRUE, with one flag	Runs created per PA .130 → .207 ; BA w/ RISP .299 → .462 — but the post-break RISP cell is 42 PA △
4	Pulling the ball in the air is part of the story	FALSE on volume — TRUE on quality	Pull-air rate 10.8% → 10.6% (14th percentile of 218 Phillies hitter-seasons). But the twelve post-break pull-airs left at 97.7 mph with 3 HR (pre: 93.7 mph)
5	He is still a guy who rarely whiffs	TRUE — more than ever	Whiff 17.3% → 12.4% (would be ~1st percentile in the pool); in-zone whiff 12.0% → 6.8% ; K% 14.9% → 9.6%
6	His approach has changed	MOSTLY FALSE	Chase .257 → .254, first-pitch swing flat, in-zone swing +2.0 pts. The decisions barely moved — the contact moved

One sentence: the surge is real and process-backed — harder contact and elite bat-to-ball on an essentially unchanged approach — but it is **not** a pull-air breakout, it is concentrated in August and in a torrid (below-floor) left-on-right split, and part of the jump is a .222 pre-break BABIP that had been running *under* his contact quality finally correcting.

§2 · Calibration — were the outcomes actually positive?

Yes, on every top-line KPI, and by margins that don't depend on where you draw the line.

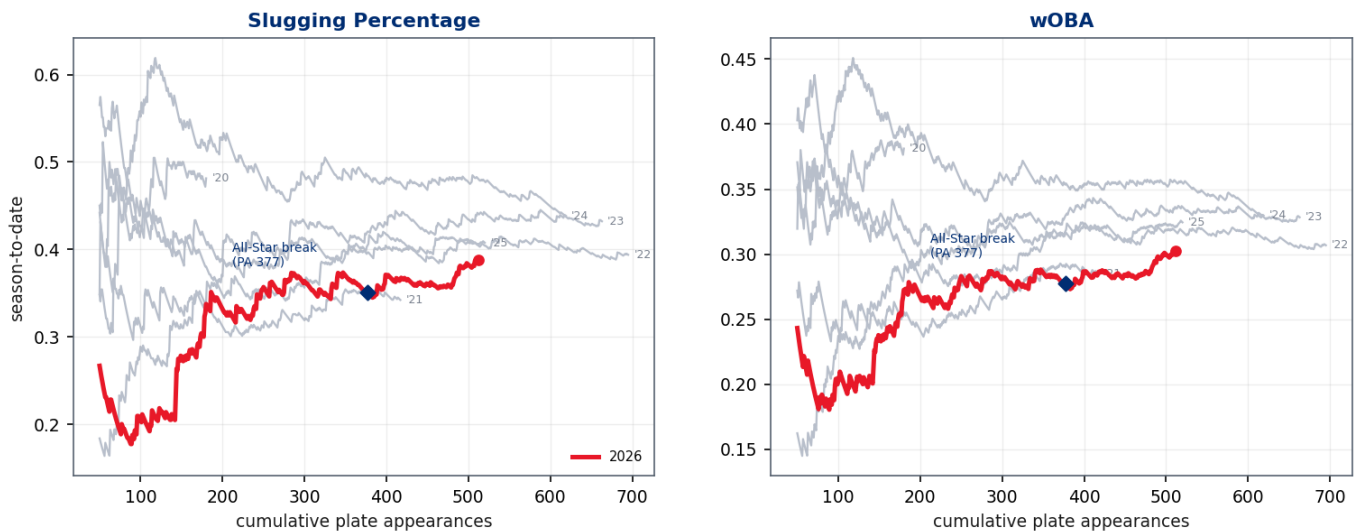
KPI	Pre-break (377 PA)	Post-break (135 PA)	Δ
SLG	.351	.488	+.137
BA	.214	.336	+.123
OBP	.276	.378	+.102
wOBA	.278	.374	+.096
BA w/ RISP	.299 (92 PA)	.462 (42 PA ▲)	+.163
SLG w/ RISP	.519	.667 ▲	+.147
Runs created	49 (.130 / PA)	28 (.207 / PA)	+.077 / PA
K%	14.9%	9.6%	−5.3 pts
BABIP	.222	.355	+.132

Context that keeps §2 honest:

- **April was a crater** — .180 wOBA over 99 PA. The recovery was underway from 1 May (monthly wOBA .346 / .293 / .313 before the break), so "since the All-Star break" compresses a longer climb into a clean narrative marker. The scan below prices both framings.
- **August is the engine.** Post-break by month: July-after-break folds into a .313 July; August alone is **.406 wOBA / .527 SLG over 81 PA** (above floor).
- The season line (.246/.303/.388, wOBA .303) still sits at the **43rd-45th percentile** of the 218 Phillies hitter-seasons since 2015 — the turnaround has repaired the season, not yet made it special. The *post-break window as a season* would sit at the **86th percentile in SLG, 93rd in wOBA**.

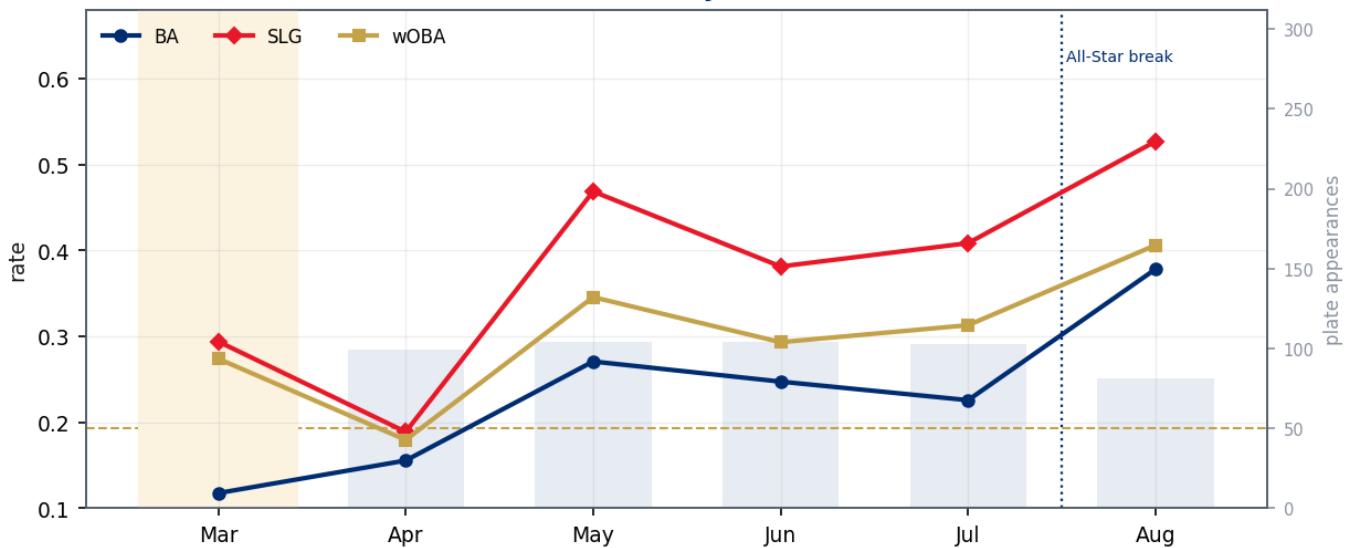
Breakpoint sensitivity (standing RC-5 requirement — the window was chosen after seeing the outcome): across ten candidate breakpoints from 1 May to 8 Aug, **Δ-wOBA and Δ-SLG are positive at every single one** — unlike other recent subject studies, there is no boundary that reverses this sign. The All-Star break is not even the strongest available split (8 Aug is, at exactly 50 post PA); it is simply a fair one.

Alec Bohm 2026 vs his own six prior seasons — cumulative results by PA

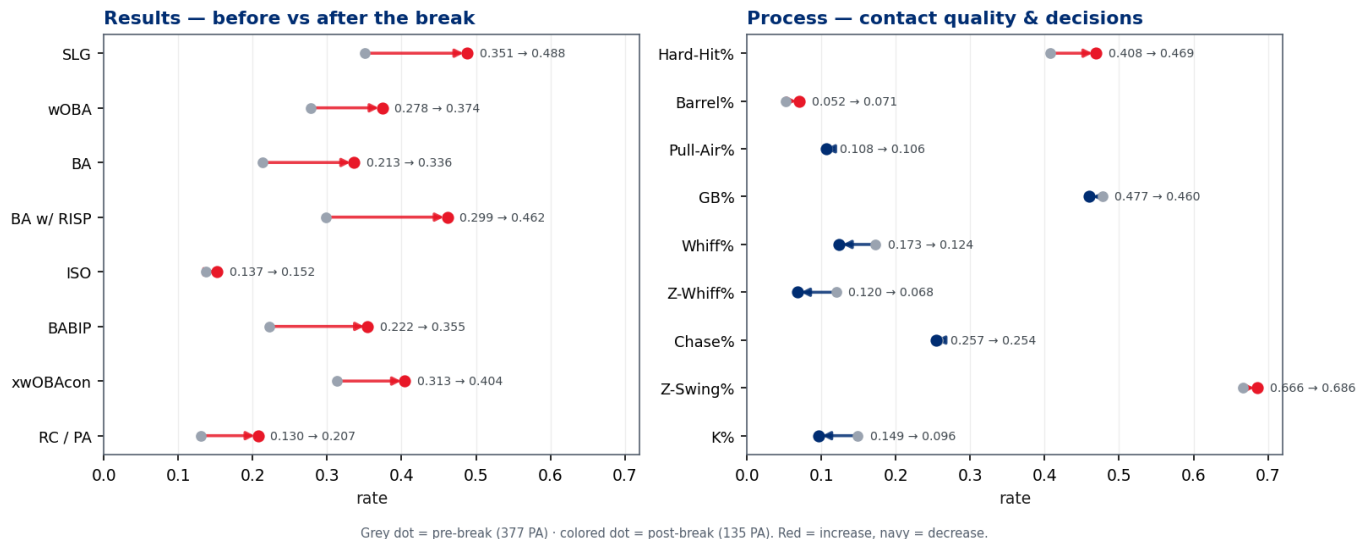


Grey = 2020–2025 self-referential ghost lines. Left tail below 50 PA suppressed. Navy diamond = the DPO break operator (post = games after 15 Jul).

Monthly results — where the surge actually lives shaded months are below the 50-PA reliability floor



§3 · The mechanism — what actually moved



Three things moved, one thing corrected, and one thing conspicuously did not move.

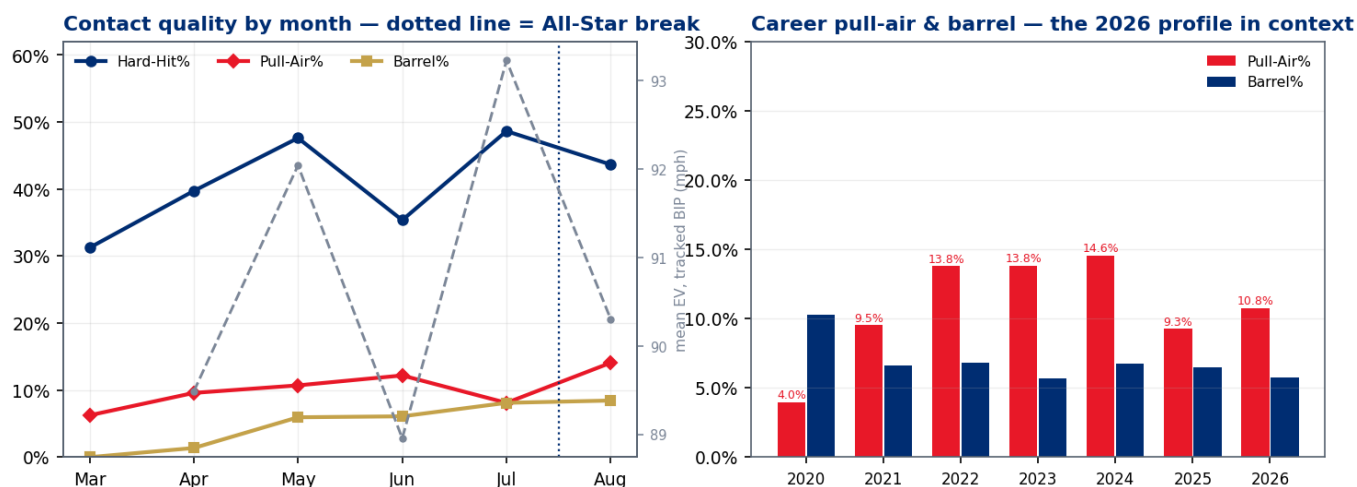
Moved — contact quality. Hard-hit rate 40.8% → 46.9% (the post-break window would rank 90th percentile in the pool), tracked mean EV 90.1 → 91.7 mph, barrels 5.2% → 7.1%, xwOBAcon .313 → .404. The expected-outcome shift (+.091) is the same size as the actual wOBA shift (+.096): **the results are riding on the contact, not on sequencing luck.**

Moved — bat-to-ball. Whiff rate 17.3% → 12.4%; in-zone whiff **cut nearly in half**, 12.0% → 6.8% (that in-zone figure would be ~2nd percentile among all Phillies hitter-seasons since 2015). K% 9.6% post-break. Premise 5 doesn't just survive — the post-break version of Bohm is the best contact hitter this franchise has rostered in the Statcast era, on this measure.

Moved — batted-ball shape at the margins. Not the launch-angle surge you might expect: mean LA actually eased 9.4° → 8.6°. The real shape change is that **popups halved** (6.3% → 2.7% of BIP) and fly balls rose (22.0% → 26.6%) — fewer wasted balls at both extremes of the angle distribution.

Corrected — BABIP. Pre-break .222 against a .313 xwOBAcon was an *under*-performance; post-break .355 with contact this hard is not an anomaly, it is the correction plus real gain. Expect the .336 BA to settle even if the process holds.

Did not move — pull-air volume. 10.8% → 10.6% of BIP, in a season already sitting at the **14th percentile** and well under his 2022–24 range (13.8–14.6%). What changed is what the pull-airs *are*: twelve of them post-break, nine hits, **three of his three post-break homers**, average exit velocity **97.7 mph** and average distance 314 ft (pre: 93.7 mph, 294 ft). He is not pulling the ball in the air more; when he does, it is louder and it is damage. Meanwhile his oppo-air game (25.7% of BIP, .417 xwOBAcon) and straightaway-air game (.650 xwOBAcon post-break) carry the volume.



The approach question (premise 6). Chase rate .257 → .254, first-pitch swing .325 → .326, overall swing +2.4 pts, in-zone swing +2.0 pts. This is not an approach overhaul — it is the same decision framework executing far better on contact. One pitcher-side note belongs beside it (these are opponent metrics, not Bohm's behaviour): **the league is challenging him more** — in-zone rate .492 → .539 — and he is answering the extra strikes with more in-zone swings and half the in-zone whiffs. First-pitch strike rate against him is identical pre/post (.593 = .593, a genuine coincidence the verification script confirms twice).

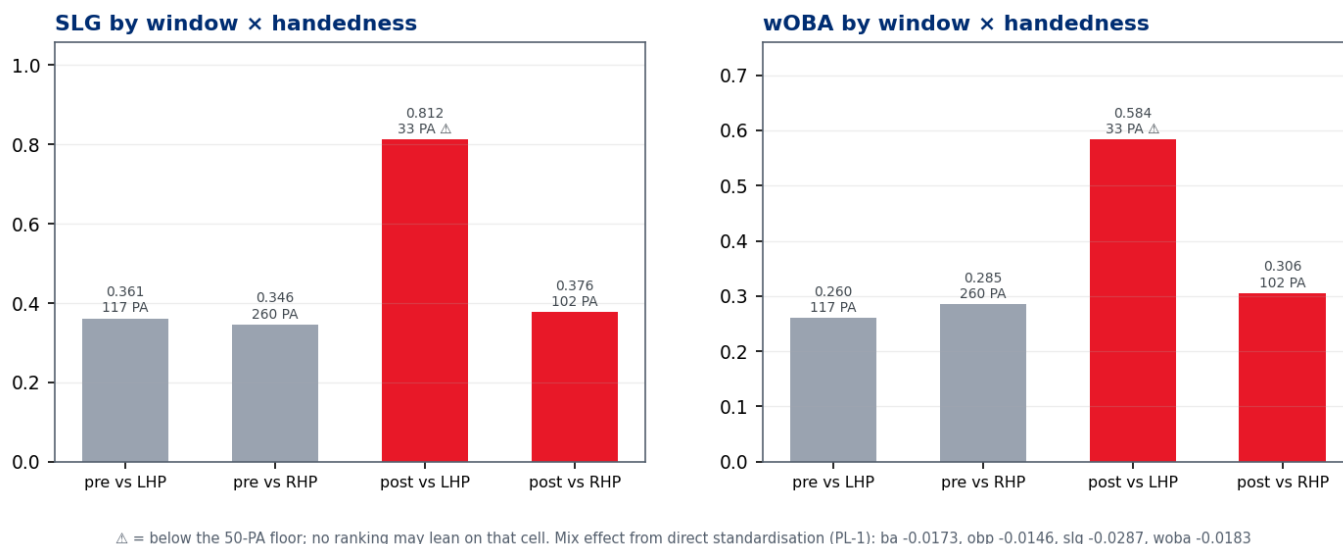
§4 · Splits — where the damage lives

Pitch groups: the breaking-ball fix is the headline

Window	Group	Pitches	PA	BA	SLG	wOBA	Whiff	Chase
pre	fastball	849	244	.218	.361	.295	14.2%	23.7%
pre	breaking	410	98	.152	.239	.187	23.4%	28.2%
pre	offspeed	118	34 [△]	.364	.606	.423	22.2%	27.8%
post	fastball	278	71	.344	.453	.382	10.9%	20.0%
post	breaking	165	51	.340	.460	.339	14.3%	32.1%
post	offspeed	39	12 [△]	.273	.818 [△]	.476 [△]	14.3%	30.4%

Pre-break, breaking balls were the entire problem: .152/.239 with a 23.4% whiff on 410 pitches. Post-break he is hitting **.340 and slugging .460 against them with a 14.3% whiff** — he chases them slightly *more* (32.1%) but touches them when he does. Fastball performance rose in parallel. Offspeed was never the issue and the post-break cell is 12 PA Δ — read nothing into it.

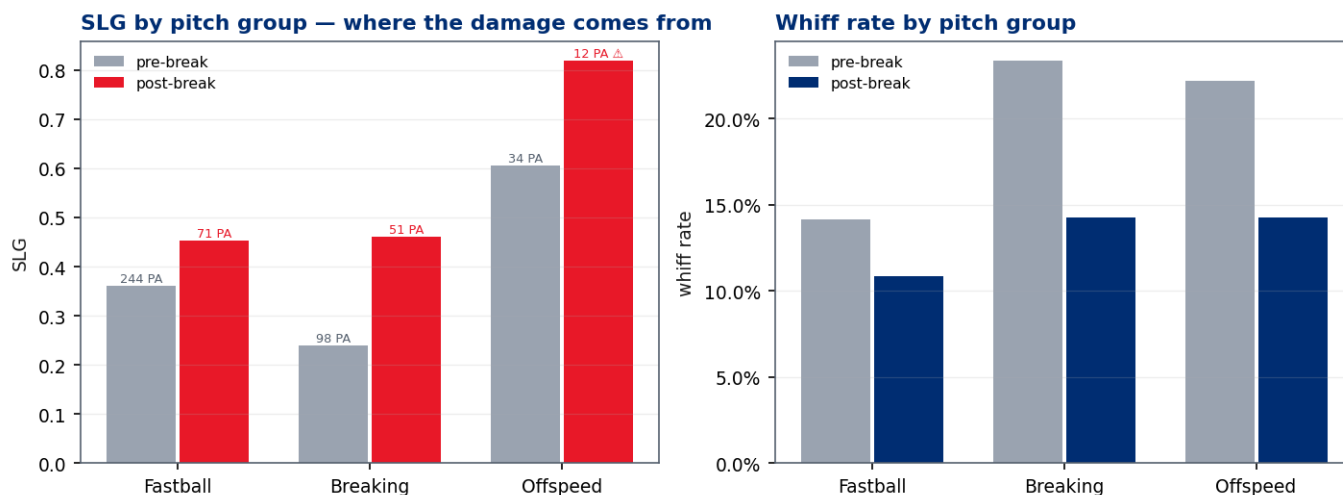
Platoon: real, loud, and below the floor



Post-break vs LHP: **.531 BA / .812 SLG / .584 wOBA — on 33 PA Δ** . Post-break vs RHP: .269/.376/.306 over 102 PA — solid, K% 11.8%, hard-hit 45.1%, but much closer to his season norm. So the headline window mixes one merely-good split with one white-hot below-floor split.

Two governance points keep this honest:

1. **The mix did not flatter him.** His LHP exposure *fell* post-break (31.0% → 24.4% of PA). Direct standardisation (PL-1) puts the mix effect at **-18 points of wOBA, -29 of SLG** — had he faced the pre-break mix, the post-break line would look *better*. The surge is performance, not scheduling.
2. **33 PA is 33 PA.** The .812 SLG cell may not survive contact with September. The vs-RHP gains (whiff 14.1%, hard-hit .451) are the part with a reliable sample behind them.



§5 · Could anyone in the Phillies Offense value stream have driven this?

The requester asked whether specific personas could have taken actions that produced these outcomes. **Direction of causation is not identified by this data product** — what follows maps each *observable correlate* to the persona whose remit it sits in, as testable hypotheses, not findings.

Observable in the data	Value-stream persona	Hypothesis worth testing
Breaking-ball line .152/.239 → .340/.460; whiff on breaking 23.4% → 14.3%	Hitting coach	A recognition/timing intervention against spin (pitch-recognition work, tee/machine mix) would look exactly like this: chase on spin <i>up</i> slightly, contact on spin way up
Popup share halved, FB share +4.6 pts, LA distribution tightened at both tails	Hitting coach / player development	Barrel-presentation or posture cue; consistent with "hit it hard, stop cutting under it" rather than an air-ball mandate
Mean EV +1.6 mph, hard-hit +6.1 pts with no swing-decision change	Strength & conditioning	Mid-season physical adjustment; also consistent with health improvement — roster/medical logs are outside this data plane (manual carry-in required)
RISP conversion: BA w/ RISP .299 → .462 △, RC/PA +.077	Manager / lineup construction	More traffic ahead of him or better leverage spotting would inflate RC/PA without any skill change — and his share of PA <i>with</i> RISP did rise, 24.4% → 31.1%. Part of the RC/PA jump is opportunity, not conversion; worth a dedicated lineup-context study
LHP exposure fell while LHP performance exploded	Manager (platoon deployment)	Not a shielding story — his LHP share <i>fell</i> . If anything the data argues for <i>more</i> LHP exposure, the opposite of a protection narrative
In-zone rate against him .492 → .539	Opponent behaviour (no Phillies persona)	Pitchers stopped nibbling — plausibly <i>because</i> his chase never spiked and his April results made challenge attractive. This is the confound to every coaching hypothesis above: some of the surge is the league volunteering strikes to a hitter who stopped missing them

The last row is the honest one: **the cleanest causal candidate in the data is the interaction — pitchers moved into the zone against a hitter whose in-zone contact was simultaneously peaking**. Whether Phillies personnel engineered that peak or merely benefited from the league's adjustment cannot be separated here.

§6 · Career context — is this a new Bohm or a familiar one?

Year	PA	BA	SLG	wOBA	K%	Whiff	Z-Whiff	Chase	Hard-Hit	Pull-Air	BA w/RISP
2020	180 △*	.338	.481	.381	20.0%	25.2%	16.6%	25.0%	46.8%	4.0%	.452
2021	417	.247	.342	.285	26.6%	26.7%	23.4%	26.0%	49.5%	9.5%	.260
2022	695	.274	.394	.307	18.1%	21.7%	16.7%	31.9%	43.5%	13.8%	.288
2023	663	.272	.432	.328	15.5%	18.8%	12.3%	30.1%	41.2%	13.8%	.335
2024	619	.275	.438	.330	13.9%	17.5%	10.4%	27.4%	45.2%	14.6%	.295
2025	520	.288	.408	.324	16.0%	14.9%	10.0%	25.6%	46.6%	9.3%	.288
2026	512	.246	.388	.303	13.5%	16.0%	10.5%	25.6%	42.5%	10.8%	.353

*2020 is a 60-game season; above the PA floor but a short-season sample.

The whiff trajectory is a six-year monotone improvement — 26.7% → 16.0% — and the post-break 12.4% is its logical endpoint, not an aberration. The pull-air decline from the 2022–24 plateau (~14%) to ~10% in 2025–26 predates this season and is a *profile drift*, not a slump artifact: 2026 Bohm trades pull-side lift for opposite-field air and contact density. His .353 BA with RISP is a career best (134 RISP PA, above floor). The season wOBA (.303) is still below his 2023–25 band — which is precisely the case for the post-break version being a *recovery to trend plus a contact peak*, rather than a brand-new hitter.

§7 · Caveats, floors, and what this product does not claim

1. **Post-break = 135 PA.** Above the floor, but five weeks. Every post-break rate here has wide error bars; the report ranks nothing on the sub-window cells that sit below 50 PA (post-RISP 42 Δ , post-LHP 33 Δ , post-offspeed 12 Δ , March 21 Δ).
 2. **The window is outcome-selected.** The DPO chose the All-Star break after watching the surge. The sensitivity scan shows the finding is boundary-robust in *sign* — the *size* of the delta still varies threefold across candidate breakpoints.
 3. **"Middle of the lineup" claims are out of scope.** Batting-order slot is not a column in this data plane; RC/PA and RISP conversion are the closest governed proxies. A lineup-context follow-up needs a batting-order carry-in.
 4. **Causation is not identified anywhere in §5.** Correlates mapped to personas are hypotheses.
 5. **Known kernel defects** D1–D6 are disclosed in 05_quality_certification.md; the `_fix` variants used here leave the governed originals untouched. `pull_air_rate` executes in this build for the first time via the O-7 remediation (`hc_x/hc_y` → derived coordinates, boundary logic verbatim, classification proven scale-invariant); its output should be treated as **provisional until the DPO ratifies the coordinate derivation**.
 6. **xwOBACon $\neq$ xwOBA** (O-4). Pre/post *shifts* are compared; levels are never compared to wOBA.
-

Receipts: `dp_uc37_*.csv` (14 files) + `dp_uc37_headlines.json` · figures `dp_uc37_fig1..6_*.png` · independent verification `dp_uc37_verification.py` — 227/227 PASS · governance trail 00–07 in this folder. Generated 2026-08-23 · Phillies Offense value stream · Data Product Owner: Kellen Short.